GRILLED WHOLE TROUT
WITH WILD BERRY RELISH

serves 2

This is the kind of dish you can make when you're camping with gathered ingredients. You can cook over a campfire, either directly on grill grates or in a cast-iron skillet. If you're not up for building a campfire, you can cook the whole fish on an outdoor grill on medium heat (at about 350°F).

- 1 cup wild berries, such as serviceberries (saskatoon), huckleberries, strawberries, or thimbleberries (or raspberries)
- 10 or so wild onion greens or chives
- 10 edible conifer needles plus 2 small conifer pieces
- Fine sea salt
- 1 whole trout, scaled and gutted (about 1½ pounds)
- 1 tablespoon sunflower oil, plus more for cooking

Build a campfire and let the wood burn down so it's smoldering and still hot but no longer a flaming fire.

While the fire is burning down, place the berries in a bowl and gently crush them with your hands. Finely chop or tear 2 of the onion greens and 1 of the conifer needles into small pieces, add them to the bowl, folding them with the berries. Season with salt.

When the fire is ready, set a cast-iron skillet directly in the coals or set a grill grate over the fire.

Rub the fish all over with the oil and season with salt. Stuff the trout cavity with the remaining onion greens and conifer pieces. Oil the skillet or grill.

Transfer the fish to the skillet or the grill and cook for 4 to 10 minutes, depending on the size of your fish and the heat of your fire, until the flesh is opaque throughout and flaky. Carefully flip the fish (use sticks or tongs if you brought them) and continue cooking until the bottom flesh is opaque and flaky.

Transfer the fish to a wooden board. Remove the skin, if desired, then gently pull the fish flesh in the top fillet from the bones and transfer to a plate. Remove the backbone and transfer the remaining fish fillet to a plate.

Serve the berry relish with the fish.